

CALYPSO PARENT RHYTHM

Parent Rhythms are all about the HOW and WHY we do what we are doing. HOW and WHY are very powerful concepts, and they are easily overlooked in our practice, in our teaching, and in our playing.

So much jazz practice and education is about the WHAT we are doing - "what mode should I use, or which diminished scale works here?" The WHAT stuff maybe seems a little cooler or sexier, and frankly is easier to talk about too. That said, the HOW and the WHY stuff is often the best path to improving quicker. A little less sexy though.

WHAT we are doing here is incredibly simple. Half notes, and eventually "embellishing half notes." WHY is a huge question, (Parent Rhythms = better groove), and the HOW we do it is actually the hard part. For this lesson, the HOW part is "great time, strong articulations, and forward momentum." Dig in and enjoy.

CHORDS TO "ST. THOMAS," BY SONNY ROLLINS

1 C⁶ F⁶ E^{m7} A⁷ D^{m7} G⁷ C⁶

5 C⁶ F⁶ E^{m7} A⁷ D^{m7} G⁷ C⁶

9 E^{ø7} A⁷ D^{m7} G⁷

13 C⁶ C⁶/E F⁶ F^{#o7} C/G G⁷ C⁶

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